

EP. 03 — SERP Analysis Guide

Understand what Google and AI search engines reward for each page — before you write a single word of content

Why This Step Cannot Be Skipped

You have the site structure — you know which pages to build. You have the page structure — you know how each page is laid out. But if you fill those pages with the wrong type of content, Google will not rank them.

SERP Analysis tells you what content Google and AI engines actually reward for each page, before you write a single word.

This is not about deciding which pages to build — that is already done. It is about understanding, for each page in your structure, what Google expects to see on it.

Where This Fits in the Series

1	Site Structure	Which pages to build
2	Page Structure	How to lay out the content on each page
3	SERP Analysis	What content Google & AI engines reward per page
4	Keyword Research	The exact terms to target on each page
5	Competitor Title & Meta	How competitors are positioning each page

How to Use This Guide with the Google Sheet

This guide and the Google Sheet work together. Open the sheet alongside this document as you go through each step. Every step below tells you exactly which tab to open and which columns to fill.

Tab	Tab Name	What You Do Here
Tab 1	EP01 — Site Structure	Your competitor list and page inventory (already done)
Tab 2	EP02 — Page Structure	Your section mapping and page blueprint (already done)
Tab 3	SERP Analysis Tracker	← You are working here in this episode
Tab 4	Result Type Guide	Reference — keep open while filling Tab 3
Tab 5	Search Intent Guide	Reference — keep open while filling Tab 3

Tab 6	GEO vs SEO Note	Reference — the thumb rule explained
Tab 7	Keyword Mapping	Coming in EP.04 — Keyword Research
Tab 8	Technical SEO	Coming later — on-page audit tracker
Tab 9	Competitor List	Coming later — competitor benchmarking
Tab 10	Content Updates	Coming later — content pipeline tracker

Start on Tab 3. Tabs 1 and 2 are already filled from EP.01 and EP.02. Tabs 4, 5, and 6 are reference guides — keep them open in separate browser tabs. Everything you fill in this episode goes into Tab 3: SERP Analysis Tracker.

At a Glance

#	Step	What you do	Sheet column
1	Open Tab 3	Set up your SERP Analysis Tracker	All columns
2	Search incognito	Run each keyword fresh	Col A: Keyword
3	Dominant result type	Classify what Google is surfacing	Col C
4	Search intent	Read the why behind the search	Col D
5	Featured snippet	Note format and owner	Col E + F + G
6	People Also Ask	Extract sub-topics and H2s	Col H + I + J
7	AI search engines	Check ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini	Col K (new)
8	Videos and local pack	Flag keywords needing video or GBP	Col L + M
9	Content format decision	Final call on what to create	Col N

Step-by-Step Walkthrough

Step 1

Open Tab 3 — SERP Analysis Tracker

Open the Google Sheet and go to **Tab 3 — SERP Analysis Tracker**. This is your working sheet for this entire episode. Each row is one keyword. Each column is one piece of data you will collect. Here is what every column means:

- **Col A — Keyword:** The exact search term you are targeting
- **Col B — Your Planned Page URL:** The slug of the page this keyword belongs to (e.g. /services/whatsapp-automation-dubai)
- **Col C — Dominant Result Type:** What Google is mostly surfacing
- **Col D — Search Intent:** Informational, Commercial, Transactional, or Navigational
- **Col E — Featured Snippet? (Y/N):** Whether a snippet box appears
- **Col F — Snippet Format:** Paragraph, Numbered List, or Table
- **Col G — Snippet Owned By:** Which competitor currently holds position zero
- **Col H, I, J — PAA Questions 1, 2, 3:** The People Also Ask questions for this keyword
- **Col K — AI Search Result Type:** What ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Gemini surface
- **Col L — Videos in Results? (Y/N):** Whether YouTube appears in organic results
- **Col M — Local Pack? (Y/N):** Whether a Google Maps box appears
- **Col N — Recommended Content Format:** Your final decision on what to create
- **Col O — Notes:** Strategic observations

[■ OPEN IN SHEET](#)

Tab 3 — SERP Analysis Tracker — Fill one complete row per keyword before moving to the next

Step 2

Search Each Keyword in Incognito

For each keyword in your site structure, open a new incognito window and search the **exact phrase** — not a variation. Read the full first page before filling in anything.

[■ OPEN IN SHEET](#)

Tab 3 — Col A — Type the exact keyword. Col B: type the planned page URL from your site structure (Tab 1)

Why incognito?

Your search history and location skew results. Incognito gives you the neutral SERP that most of your target audience would see.

Step 3

Identify the Dominant Result Type

Look at the first 7 to 10 organic results — skip ads. Count which result type appears most. That is what Google has decided satisfies this keyword. Use **Tab 4 — Result Type Guide** as your reference.

Result Type	What It Looks Like	What It Signals
Blog Post	"How to", "What is", "Guide to" in titles	Informational — write content
Landing Page	Service page, pricing page, product page	Transactional — build a conversion page
Listicle	"Best X", "Top 10 Y" in titles	Commercial — write a comparison

Video	YouTube results in main organic feed	Visual — produce video alongside text
Local Pack	Map with 3 business listings	Local — needs Google Business + location page
Forum/Community	Reddit, Quora in top results	Unmet intent — opportunity to own the answer

■ OPEN IN SHEET

Tab 3 — Col C — Type the dominant result type. If mixed, write 'Mixed' and note the top 3 format

Reference
Tab 4.

Tab 4 — Result Type Guide has this same table always available. Keep it open in a separate browser tab while you work.

Step 4

Read the Search Intent

Intent is the reason behind the search. The result type tells you *what* — intent tells you *why*. Use **Tab 5 — Search Intent Guide** as your reference.

Intent	What the Searcher Wants	GEO Implication	Content to Create
Informational	To learn or understand something	High — AI cites educational content heavily	Blog post / guide / explainer
Commercial	Comparing options before deciding	Medium — AI cites listicles and reviews	Comparison article / listicle
Transactional	Ready to act — buy, sign up, book	Low — AI rarely cites sales pages	Landing page with clear CTA
Navigational	Looking for a specific brand	None — do not target	Skip this keyword

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Tab 3 — Col D — Type the intent type. Reference Tab 5 — Search Intent Guide for the full breakdown

Step 5

Check for a Featured Snippet

A featured snippet appears above the organic results — position zero. If one is present, note:

- Is it a **paragraph** — a direct 40–60 word answer?
- Is it a **numbered list** — a step-by-step process?
- Is it a **table** — a comparison or data set?
- Which site currently owns it?

The format tells you exactly how to structure your answer. A numbered list snippet means your page needs a clearly numbered section. A paragraph snippet means write a concise direct answer near the top.

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Tab 3 — Col E, F, G — E: Y or N. F: Paragraph / Numbered List / Table. G: the domain that owns it

Snippet ownership changes.

A better-structured answer on a stronger page can displace the current owner. This is one of the fastest ways to reach position zero.

Step 6

Read People Also Ask

The PAA box contains questions Google surfaces alongside your keyword. These represent the sub-topics searchers expect a good page to cover. Write every question down.

- These become your **H2 subheadings** on the page
- These become your **FAQ section** below the main content
- Each PAA question can become its own future article

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Tab 3 — Col H, I, J — Copy the first 3 PAA questions exactly as they appear on Google

PAA expands as you click.

Click any PAA question to reveal more below it. Expand 2 or 3 to find deeper sub-topics for your content brief.

Step 7

Check AI Search Engines

Take the same keyword and search it on **ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Gemini**. Note what the AI surfaces in its answer:

- What type of content is the AI citing — blog posts, landing pages, listicles?
- Is it the same format as what Google is ranking?
- Which specific sites or sources is the AI pulling from?

The SEO / GEO Thumb Rule

If you do SEO properly — the right format, the right structure, the right content — you will automatically get cited on AI searches. ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini, and Google AI Overviews all pull from the same well-structured content that Google already ranks. **GEO is not a separate strategy. It is the reward for doing SEO right.**

The Exception. Highly conversational queries asked directly to AI — not Googled — may pull from different sources. Example: someone asking ChatGPT 'what WhatsApp tool should I use for my restaurant?' is not Googling anything. The AI may pull from Reddit, product directories, or training data. Check these manually and create a second content format if needed.

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Tab 3 — Col K — Type what format ChatGPT / Perplexity / Gemini surfaces. If it matches Google write 'Matches Google'. If different, describe the format.

Step 8

Note Videos and Local Pack

Videos in results:

If YouTube videos appear in the organic results — even one or two — Google considers video relevant. A written page alone may underperform. Plan a video to embed alongside it.

Local pack:

If a map with three business listings appears, the keyword has local intent.

- A generic landing page will not rank for this keyword
- You need a location-specific page targeting that city or area
- Your Google Business Profile must be optimised and verified for that location
- NAP consistency — Name, Address, Phone — across all directories matters

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Tab 3 — Col L and Col M — L: Videos in Results — Y or N. M: Local Pack — Y or N

Step 9

Make the Content Format Decision

Based on everything you have logged — result type, intent, snippet, PAA, AI search, videos, local pack — make one final call for each keyword. This is the most important column in the sheet.

If you see this...	Create this content format
Mostly blog posts	Long-form blog post or guide (1500+ words)
Mostly landing pages	Dedicated conversion page with clear CTA
Mostly listicles	Comparison or best-of article
YouTube videos in organic results	Video + supporting written page
Local map pack	Location page + Google Business Profile
Reddit or Quora in top 5	Long-form answer article — own this gap
AI matches Google format	Follow the SEO format — GEO will follow
AI differs from Google	Create both formats and cross-link them
Mixed — no clear winner	Use dominant format from positions 1–3

■ OPEN IN SHEET

Tab 3 — Col N — Type your final content format decision. This column drives everything that comes next — keyword research and content writing.

Why This Works

Google's first page tells you, with more precision than any keyword tool, what searchers actually want and what content satisfies them. You are reading that signal directly — before you invest time writing anything.

By adding the AI search check, you now cover both traditional search and generative AI in one step. In most cases they align — do the SEO right and GEO follows. When they diverge, you have a specific action to take.

Episode	What You Now Have
EP.01 — Site Structure	You know which pages to build
EP.02 — Page Structure	You know how each page is laid out
EP.03 — SERP Analysis	You know what content each page needs
EP.04 — Keyword Research	Coming next — Tab 7 in your sheet
EP.05 — Competitor Title & Meta	Coming next — builds on Tab 9